



OCHNA

OCHNACEAE

Genus of mainly deciduous or semi-evergreen trees and shrubs, grown mostly for their flowers and fruits. Frost tender. Prefers full light and well-drained soil. Water potted specimens moderately, less when not in growth. Prune, if necessary, in early spring. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer. ***O. multiflora***. See *O. serrulata*. ***O. serratifolia*** of gardens. See *O. serrulata*. ***O. serrulata***, syn. *O. multiflora*, *O. serratifolia* of gardens (Mickey-mouse plant). Evergreen, irregularly rounded, twiggy shrub that is semievergreen in low temperatures. H to 6ft (2m), S 3–6ft (1–2m) or more. Leaves are narrowly elliptic, toothed, and glossy. Produces 5-petaled, bright yellow flowers in spring-summer, then shuttlecock-shaped, red fruits, each with 1–5 berrylke seeds clustered on top. Z10–12 (min. 45°F/7°C).

- x *Odontioda***. See *Oncidium* and *x Oncostele*
- x *Odontocidium***. See *Oncidium*.
- Odontoglossum bictoniense***. See *Rhynchostele bictoniense*.
- Odontoglossum Buttercrisp* gx.** See *Oncidium Buttercrisp* gx.
- Odontoglossum cervantesii***. See *Rhynchostele cervantesii*.
- Odontoglossum cordatum***. See *Rhynchostele cordata*.
- Odontoglossum crispum***. See *Oncidium alexandrae*.
- Odontoglossum Eric Young* gx.** See *Oncidium Eric Young* gx.
- Odontoglossum grande***. See *Rossioglossum grande*.
- Odontoglossum Le Nez Point* gx.** See *Oncidium Le Nez Point* gx.
- Odontoglossum rossii***. See *Rhynchostele rossii*.
- Odontoglossum Royal Occasion* gx.** See *Oncidium Royal Occasion* gx.

OEMPLERIA

syn. NUTTALLIA, OSMARONIA

ROSACEAE

Genus of one species of deciduous, early spring-flowering shrub, grown for its fragrant flowers and decorative fruits. Separate male and female plants are needed in order to obtain fruits. Fully hardy. Prefers sun or partial shade and moist soil. To restrict growth, remove suckers and cut old shoots bacor down to base in late winter. Propagate by suckers in fall. ***O. cerasiformis*** (Indian plum, Oregon plum, Oso berry). Deciduous, upright, then arching shrub that forms dense thickets. H 8ft (2.5m), S 12ft (4m). Leaves are narrowly ovate and dark blue-green. Produces nodding clusters of small, fragrant, bell-shaped, white flowers in early spring, followed by small, plum-shaped, purple fruits. Z6–10

OENOTHERA

Evening primrose

ONAGRACEAE

Genus of annuals, biennials, and perennials, grown for their profuse but short-lived, often fragrant, flowers borne in summer. Fully to half hardy. Needs full sun and well-drained, sandy soil. Propagate by seed or division in fall or spring, or by softwood cuttings in late spring. ***O. acaulis***. Tuft-forming perennial. H 6in (15cm), S 8in (20cm). Has oblong to ovate, deeply toothed or lobed leaves. Cup-shaped, white flowers, turning pink, open at sunset in summer. Z4–10 ***O. biennis*** (Evening primrose). Erect, hairy annual or biennial, usually grown as a biennial. H 3–5ft (1–1.5m), S to 2ft (60cm). Produces large rosettes of oblong to lance-shaped, shallowly toothed, slightly sticky, red-veined, mid-green leaves, and lance-shaped stem leaves. Bowl-shaped, fragrant flowers, to 2in (5cm) across, initially pale yellow, aging to dark golden yellow, and opening in the evening, are borne in leafy, spikelike racemes from summer to fall. Seeds are used to produce evening primrose oil. Z4–9 ***O. caespitosa***. Clump-forming, stemless perennial. H 5in (12cm), S 8in (20cm). Has narrowly ovate, entire or toothed, mid-green leaves. Flowers, opening at sunset in summer, are fragrant, cup-shaped, and white, becoming pink with age. Suits a rock garden. Z4–10 ***O. fruticosa* ‘Fireworks’**. See *O.f. ‘Fyrverkeri’*. **‘Fyrverkeri’** (syn. *O.f. ‘Fireworks’*) illus. p.275. ***O. lindheimeri***. See *Gaura lindheimeri*. ***O. macrocarpa***, syn. *O. missouriensis*, illus. p.372. ***O. missouriensis***. See *O. macrocarpa*. ***O. perennis***, syn. *O. pumila*. Clump-forming perennial. H 6–4in (15–60cm), S 1ft (30cm). In summer, loose spikes of nodding buds open to fragrant, funnel-shaped, yellow flowers above spoon-shaped, mid-green leaves. Z4–8 ***O. pumila***. See *O. perennis*. ***O. speciosa*** (White evening primrose). Frequently short-lived, clump-forming perennial, with running rhizomes. H 1½ft (45cm), S 1ft (30cm) or more. In summer, produces spikes of fragrant, saucer-shaped, green-centered, white flowers that age to pink and open flat. Leaves are narrowly spoon-shaped, deeply cut, and mid-green. Z4–8

OLEA

OLEACEAE

Genus of evergreen trees, grown for their foliage and edible fruits. Frost hardy; in cold areas requires the protection of a sheltered, south- or west-facing wall. Requires full sun and deep, fertile, very well-drained soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer or by seed in fall. ***O. europaea*** (Olive). Slow-growing, evergreen, spreading tree. H and S 30ft (10m). Very long-lived. Narrowly oblong leaves are gray-green above, silvery beneath. Short racemes of tiny, fragrant, white flowers, borne in late summer, are followed by edible, ovate, green, later purple fruits. Z8–10

OLEARIA

Daisy bush

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs, small trees, and some perennials, grown for their foliage and daisylike flower heads. In mild, coastal areas provides good, very wind-resistant shelter. Borderline frost hardy to frost tender. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Cut out dead wood in spring. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer. ***O. albida*** of gardens. See *O. ‘Talbot de Malahide’*. ***O. avicenniifolia***. Evergreen, rounded, dense shrub. H 10ft (3m), S 15ft (5m). Ovate to lance-shaped, dark gray-green leaves are white beneath. Bears wide heads of fragrant, white flowers in late summer and early fall. Z7–10 ***O. x haastii*** (Daisy bush) illus. p.130. ***O. ‘Henry Travers’***, syn. *O. semidentata* of gardens. Evergreen, rounded, compact shrub. H and S 10ft (3m). Has white shoots and narrowly lance-shaped, leathery, gray-green leaves. Large heads of purple-centered, lilac flowers are borne from early to midsummer. Z9–11 ***O. ilicifolia*** (Mountain holly) illus. p.130. ***O. lacunosa***. Evergreen, upright, dense shrub. H and S 10ft (3m). Narrowly oblong, pointed, rigid leaves have rust-brown hairs when young and mature to glossy, dark green with central, white veins. Bears white flowerheads only rarely. Z9–11 ***O. macrodonta*** illus. p.132. ***O. x mollis***. Evergreen, rounded, dense shrub. H 3ft (1m), S 5ft (1.5m). Has ovate, wavy-edged, silvery-gray leaves. Large heads of small, white flowers are borne profusely in late spring. Z7–10. **‘Zennorensis’**, H and S 6ft (2m), has narrowly oblong leaves. ***O. nummulariifolia*** illus. p.128. ***O. phlogopappa***. Evergreen, upright, compact shrub. H and S 6ft (2m). Leaves are gray-green and oblong, with wavy edges. Bears abundant, white flower heads in late spring. Z7–10. **var. subrepanda** illus. p.149. **var. subrepanda ‘Comber’s Blue’** has flowers with mid-blue ray florets. **var. subrepanda ‘Comber’s Pink’** has flowers with pink ray florets. ***O. x scilloniensis*** illus. p.131. ***O. semidentata*** of gardens. See *O. ‘Henry Travers’*.

O. ‘Talbot de Malahide’, syn. *O. albida* of gardens. Evergreen, bushy, dense shrub. H 10ft (3m), S 15ft (5m). Has ovate, dark green leaves, silvery beneath. Bears broad heads of fragrant, white flowers in late summer. Good for exposed, coastal gardens. Z9–11 ***O. virgata*** illus. p.112.

Oliveranthus elegans. See *Echeveria harmsii*.

OLSYNIUM

IRIDACEAE

Genus of fibrous-rooted, clump-forming perennials, grown for their nodding, trumpet- to bell-shaped flowers in spring. Good for a shady rock garden, peat bed, or alpine house. Fully hardy. Requires partial shade and moist, humus-rich,

moderately fertile soil. Propagate by seed in fall. Young plants take 2 or 3 years to flower.

O. biflorum, syn. *Phaiophleps biflora*, *Sisyrinchium odoratissimum*. Slender, clump-forming, rhizomatous perennial. H 10–14in (25–35cm), S 2–3in (5–8cm). Has upright stems with cylindrical, rushlike, erect, basal leaves. In late spring or summer, produces a small head of fragrant, pendent, trumpet-shaped, white flowers that are striped and veined red. H5 ***O. douglasii***, syn. *Sisyrinchium douglasii*, *S. grandiflorum* (Grass widow, Spring bell). Stiff, upright, clump-forming, deciduous perennial. H 10in (25cm), S 6in (15cm). Has grasslike, linear, grayish-green leaves sheathing very short, threadlike, flowering stems. In early spring, produces a succession of pendent, bell-shaped, violet to red-purple, or sometimes white, flowers. Suits a rock garden or alpine house. H5

OMPHALODES

BORAGINACEAE

Genus of annuals, biennials, and perennials, some of which are evergreen or semievergreen. Provides good ground-cover, especially in rock gardens. Fully to frost hardy. Needs shade or partial shade and moist but well-drained soil, except for *O. linifolia* and *O. luciliae*, which enjoy sun. Propagate by seed or division in spring. ***O. cappadocica*** illus. p.334. **‘Cherry Ingram’** illus. p.261. ***O. linifolia*** (Venus’s navelwort) illus. p.299. ***O. luciliae***. Semievergreen, mound-forming perennial. H 3in (7cm), S 6in (15cm). Has ovate, blue-gray leaves. In spring-summer, loose sprays of pink buds develop into flattish, sky-blue flowers. Resents winter wet; plant in a sheltered site or alpine house. Prefers full sun and very gritty soil. Z6–9 ***O. verna*** illus. p.334.

OMPHALOGRAMMA

PRIMULACEAE

Genus of perennials, closely related to *Primula*, grown for their flowers. Good rock garden plants, but are difficult to grow, especially in hot, dry areas. Fully hardy. Needs shade and gritty, moist but well-drained, peaty soil. Propagate by seed in spring. ***O. vinciflorum***. Basal-rosetted perennial. H 6in (15cm), S 4in (10cm). Has ovate to oblong, hairy leaves that are mid-green. In spring, produces nodding, funnel-shaped, violet flowers, each with a deeper violet throat and a flat, flared mouth. Z6–9

ONCIDIUM

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS. ***O. alexandrae***, syn. *Odontoglossum crispum* (illus. p.466). Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for a cool greenhouse or conservatory. H 6in (15cm). Bears long sprays of rounded flowers, 3in (8cm) across, white or spotted or flushed with pink, each with a red-and-yellow-marked lip; flowering season varies. Has narrowly